

Stephanie Hays

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Experience

The Washington Post, Washington, D.C.

Senior Designer | April 2025 – Present

Designer | March 2022 – April 2025

- Creates design systems for large-scale, cross-platform projects by determining the visual direction and establishing brand guidelines
- Designs and codes thoughtful, story-led presentations for stories, ensuring the piece is responsive on all platforms
- Art directs and hires freelance illustrators, determining the visual style needed for a story and providing feedback on their work
- Designs Instagram carousels that increase engagement by collaborating with the social team and photo editing or illustrating as needed
- Pitches ideas to improve the design team as a whole, including an inspiration board for designers to reference and streamlining our award submission process
- Designed print layouts for the newspaper, including Sunday A1, the weekly travel section and inside news pages

Society for News Design Creative Competition, Remote

Administrative Chair | August 2024 – May 2026

Chair of Outreach and Promotion | May 2020 – August 2024

Committee Member | October 2019 – May 2020

- Created and set up the workflow for a three-day in-person judging with 40 judges, 36 volunteers and over 4,000 entries
- Determined potential problem spots and redundancies in the competition workflow and wrote automations to streamline the process and reduce errors
- Led a team of 10 people by determining work priorities and individual assignments
- Wrote detailed documentation for judges and volunteers, including for a remote judging team in Singapore in 2026 and for 17 global volunteers on four different continents when the competition was virtual in 2021 and 2022

The Seattle Times, Seattle, Wash.

Designer | December 2019 – February 2022

- Art directed and designed Sunday features and opinion sections by collaborating with illustrators, photo editors and section editors
- Conceptualized, created and art directed special sections with unique themes
- Led monthly Inspiration & Collaboration meetings to foster innovative visual storytelling and facilitate communication between teams
- Designed the local news section on a daily deadline while collaborating with section editors, photo editors and other designers
- Coded and designed interactive websites for feature articles

Sacramento Business Journal, Sacramento, Calif.

Lead Designer | May 2018 – December 2019

- Designed 24-40 print pages of content each week, including A1, business, opinion, infographic and photo pages
- Art directed and created special sections for both print and online, collaborating with the photographer, reporters and editors
- Conceptualized cover designs and corresponding inside layouts to ensure cohesive storytelling

Skills

Adobe Creative Suite, React, Next.js, HTML, CSS, JavaScript, Figma, Microsoft 365, Airtable, Zapier, Methode, Award Force

Digital Design, Art Direction, Print Design, Project Management, Social Media, Digital Photography, Data Visualization, AP Style

Awards & Honors

Society for News Design

Best in Show

- Combination Print & Digital, 2024

Gold Medal

- Portfolio: International Staff, 2026

Silver Medals

- Print: Individual Portfolio, 2024
- Print: Inside Pages (News), 2024
- Print: Single Section, 2024

Bronze Medals

- Illustration: National, 2026
- Line of Coverage: National, 2026
- Use of Multimedia: Video, 2026

The Pulitzer Prizes

- National Reporting, 2024

The Gerald Loeb Awards

- International Finalist, 2025

Programs

Executive Leadership Program

Asian American Journalists Association, 2021

Education

Elon University

May 2018 | *summa cum laude*
BA in Communication Design
Minors in Mathematics and Art